JPM Steel | Daily Despatch

BSL 1H27 EBIT guidance upgrade to ~$1.1b (cons. $924m); Asian spreads -1%

Figure 1: Key prices and spreads

US$/mt unless stated otherwise	Close Price 23-Oct-26	% Change 1D	1W	1M	3M	12M
Steel Spreads						
BSL: ASP Domestic Indicative Spread (Lagged) - 3M Fwd.	**221**	**-1%**	**2%**	**15%**	**-15%**	**11%**
BSL: North Star Indicative Spread (Lagged) - 1M Fwd.	**927**	**0%**	**2%**	**9%**	**20%**	**93%**
BSL: Glenbrook Indicative Spread (Lagged) - 1M Fwd.	**286**	**-2%**	**1%**	**7%**	**-5%**	**10%**
BSL: Despatch-Weighted Indicative Spread (Lagged)	**538**	**0%**	**0%**	**3%**	**3%**	**54%**
BSL: ASP Domestic Indicative Spread (Spot)	219	-1%	0%	2%	-2%	22%
BSL: North Star Indicative Spread (Spot)	926	0%	2%	9%	19%	91%
BSL: Glenbrook Indicative Spread (Spot)	285	0%	0%	0%	2%	16%
Steel Prices						
HRC CFR Southeast Asia	532	0%	0%	0%	4%	15%
HRC US EXW Indiana (US$/st)	1,320	0%	2%	6%	13%	60%
Plate Delivered US Midwest (US$/st)	1,540	0%	3%	4%	12%	47%
Plate - HRC Spread US (US$/st)	104	0%	0%	-12%	1%	9%
H-Beam CFR Southeast Asia	589	0%	0%	0%	-1%	4%
Rebar CFR Southeast Asia	505	0%	0%	-1%	1%	8%
US 304 Stainless CRC EXW US mill	3,902	0%	0%	1%	4%	11%
Input Prices						
Raw Material						
IODEX 61% Fe CFR China	91	1%	0%	-5%	-7%	-14%
Premium Low Vol HCC FOB Australia	267	0%	0%	-3%	20%	39%
Pig Iron CIF New Orleans	495	0%	0%	1%	-3%	18%
Ferrous Scrap						
#1 Busheling Scrap N Amer Dom Prod Dlvd Mill	477	0%	0%	3%	5%	26%
HMS FOB US East Coast	360	0%	0%	-1%	6%	12%
HMS 1/2 80:20 CFR East Asia	389	0%	0%	0%	5%	13%
Non-Ferrous Scrap & Memory Chip (Sims SLS Segment)						
North America Zorba 90% NF Aluminium Scrap Spot (USc/lb)	80	1%	1%	-6%	-4%	3%
Copper No1 BareBright Scrap (USc/lb)	651	2%	-1%	-3%	3%	27%
DRAM Spot Price - DDR4 8Gb (US$)	32.38	0%	-1%	-2%	-3%	393%
DRAM Spot Price - DDR5 16Gb (US$)	52.22	1%	2%	4%	9%	308%
FX & Equities						
FX & Share Prices						
BSL (A$)	32.36	0%	1%	8%	0%	50%
SGM (A$)	19.26	-4%	-9%	-21%	-27%	33%
AUD/USD (A$/US$)	0.70	0%	1%	0%	1%	8%
Offshore Share Prices						
S&P 1500 Steel (Index)	690	1%	1%	4%	5%	57%
Nucor (US$)	258	0%	1%	5%	7%	86%
Steel Dynamics (US$)	242	1%	0%	3%	0%	60%
Cleveland-Cliffs (US$)	14	7%	15%	8%	27%	6%
Worthington Steel (US$)	41	1%	3%	18%	14%	31%
Nippon Steel (JPY)	654	-2%	2%	-6%	8%	6%
ArcelorMittal (EUR)	53	-1%	-6%	-16%	-8%	60%
Fiscal HY Avg. Lagged Spreads (Historical BSL Reported)	**2H24**	**1H25**	**2H25**	**1H26**	**2H26**	**1H27**
BSL: ASP Domestic Indicative Spread (Lagged) - 3M Fwd.	150	214	200	194	175	230
BSL: North Star Indicative Spread (Lagged) - 1M Fwd.	512	316	419	477	617	825
**Every +/-US$10/mt US spread movement = +/-A$21m EBIT per half. ASP has similar sensitivity depending on driver of spread change.*						

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., S&P Global Platts, J.P. Morgan.

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Key news flow and commentary

- **BlueScope Steel upgrades 1H27 EBIT guidance.** It now expects EBIT to be "approaching $1.1bn" (vs. prev. guidance range $860-960m, cons. $924m). The increase is primarily driven by stronger US steel spreads (BSL now assumes US$810/t vs. US $750/t prior) supporting North Star, along with improved performance at BCPNA and ASP. ***JPM Note:*** *We believe 80% of the North Star uplift is spread-driven, with the remainder being higher production volumes as the team pushes hard to produce more tonnes at spot pricing (we believe together these account for ~$140-150m of the ~$190m 1HFY27 EBIT uplift at the guidance midpoint). We believe the remainder of the upgrade is broadly made up equally by ASP and BCPNA (~$20m EBIT each). The remainder segments appear to track in-line with prior guidance*. Source: Company reports, Bloomberg Finance L.P.
- **Latimore lines up Indonesian billionaire family for Whyalla steel bid:** Coal billionaire Matt Latimore plans to bring on board one of Indonesia's richest families, the Widjaja family, as a minority shareholder if he succeeds in his bid for the Whyalla steelworks, as the sale process for the ailing facility drags on. M Resources is working with Singapore-based Golden Energy and Resources, controlled by the Widjaja family, on the Whyalla bid, a spokesman said, but stressed that GEAR would hold a minority stake and Latimore's company would own and operate the business. Source: AFR
- **Pacific Steel's Mojave Micro Mill to bring 700 jobs to California:** Pacific Steel Group broke ground on its Mojave Micro Mill in Kern County, just outside Los Angeles, earlier this year. It marked what California Governor Gavin Newsom recently touted as the first steel mill to break ground in the state in more than 50 years. The plant is scheduled to begin commissioning in the first quarter of 2027, and the facility is expected to produce ~380,000 short tons of seismic-grade rebar per year with zero process emissions. Source: SMU
- **Reliance says caution around foreign buys makes import flood unlikely:** Reliance said it remains focused on domestic sourcing. Management said the company buys most material from US suppliers to support domestic manufacturing and better manage lead times. The company continues to import into markets traditionally served by foreign steel, including the West Coast and the Gulf region. But President and CEO Karla Lewis noted that higher freight costs, geopolitical uncertainty, and delivery timing were making companies more cautious about importing. Source: SMU
- **Global raw steel output down again in September:** Global raw steel production slowed for the fourth straight month in September. After falling 3.4% MoM in August, the total volume of raw steel produced around the globe ticked down 1.2% to an estimated 142.4 million mt in September. On a 12MMA basis, annual production has averaged 149.3 million mt per month across the past year. This was down 1.6% YoY. Source: SMU
- **US ferrous scrap imports, exports increase in August:** US ferrous scrap imports rebounded 15% month over month in August to 340,091 metric tons, recovering from July's 295,694 mt and up 11% from 306,252 mt in August 2025, according to S&P Global Market Intelligence's Global Trade Atlas Oct. 23. The increase was broad-based, with Canada posting a strong month and prime scrap imports from Europe rising sharply, while Mexican imports fell. Source: Platts
- **South Korea imposes 5-year antidumping duties on Chinese galvanized steel:** South Korea has recommended that galvanized cold-rolled steel from China will be subject to five years of antidumping duties, the Ministry of Trade, Industry and Resources said in a statement on Oct. 23. Citing a final determination by the Korea Trade Commission, the implementation comes after provisional duties were imposed in May as a result of the commission's recommendation in April. Source: Platts
- **First new steel mill in Australia in 35 years to be the first to be powered 100% by renewables:** The first new steel mill to be built in Australia in more than 35 years will also be the first to contract its electricity supply entirely from renewables, after striking a deal with mining giant BHP to use capacity it is no longer using. Generation Steel, an Australian company formerly known as Green Steel WA, intends to invest A$850m to build an EAF mill at Collie, a town that is transitioning away from coal to new green industries in the south-west of Western Australia. Source: Renew Economy

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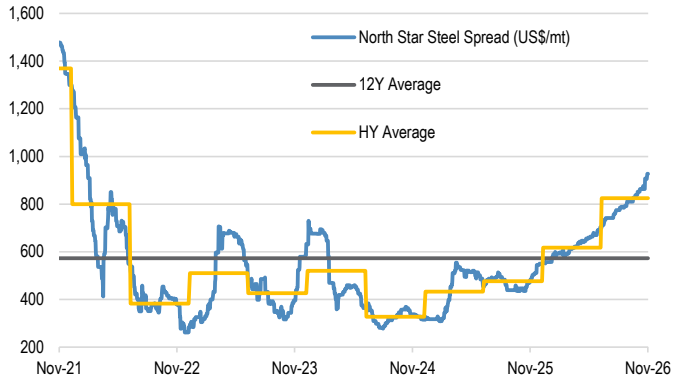
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Key charts

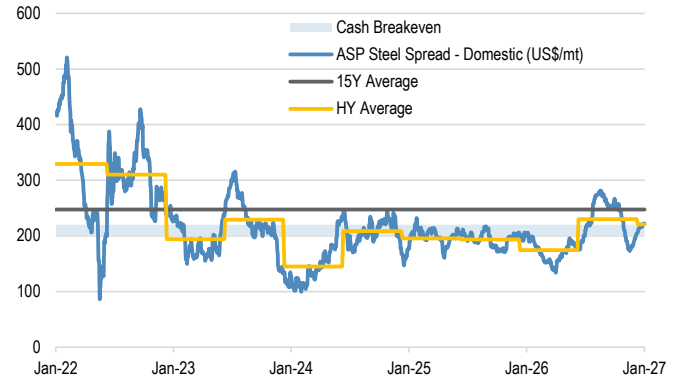
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Figure 2: North Star lagged spread



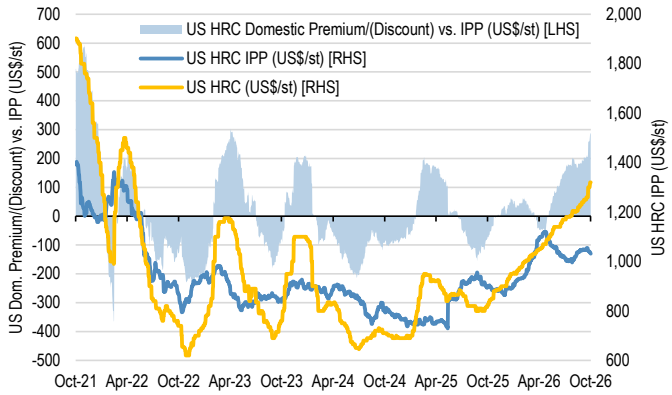
Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., Platts, J.P. Morgan.

Figure 3: Australian Steel Products lagged spread



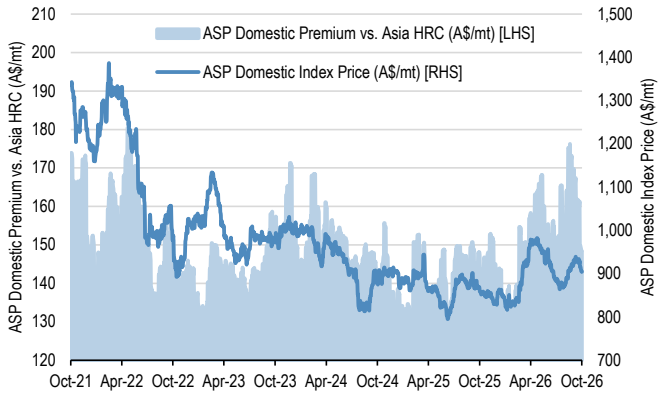
Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., Platts, J.P. Morgan.

Figure 4: US HRC domestic premium vs. Asia IPP



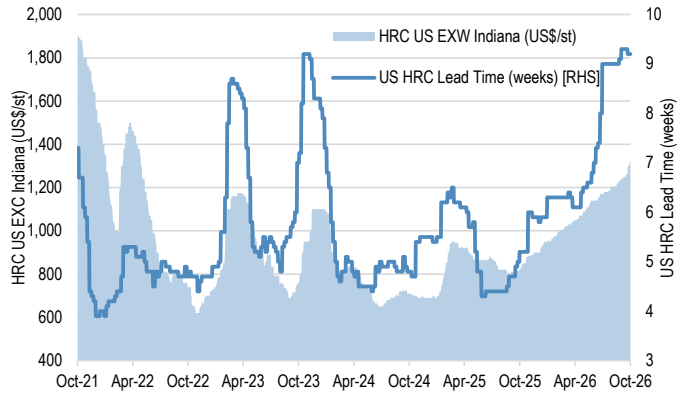
Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., Platts, J.P. Morgan.

Figure 5: ASP HRC domestic premium vs. Asia benchmark



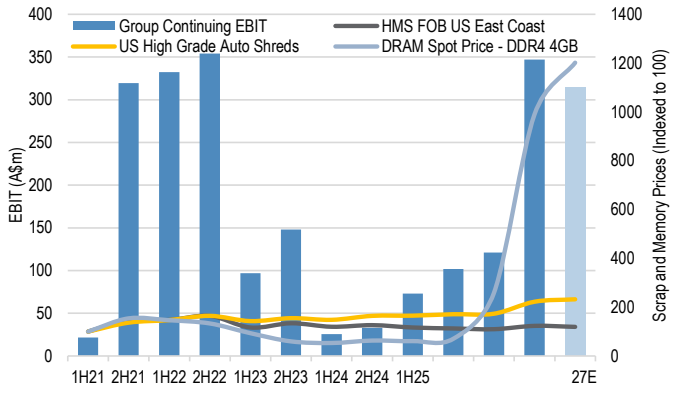
Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., Platts, J.P. Morgan.

Figure 6: US HRC vs. steel lead times



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., Platts, J.P. Morgan.

Figure 7: SGM EBIT vs. scrap and memory prices (indexed to 100)



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., Platts, J.P. Morgan estimates.

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